which is better for reverse engineering a short ai drama video. claude code or gemini?

If your goal is **reverse-engineering a short AI drama video**—meaning you want to take an existing video and reconstruct:

- the exact story/plot
- scene-by-scene breakdown
- character descriptions
- camera angles and movements
- composition
- lighting
- environment
- actions/expression
- dialogue/voiceover
- sound effects
- pacing/timestamps
- image/video-generation prompts
- eventually a **production-ready storyboard**

then **Gemini is the better choice**, especially for the *video analysis* stage.

Gemini vs Claude Code

Task	Gemini	Claude Code
Analyze original video directly	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐
Understand visual scenes	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐⭐⭐
Timestamp analysis	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐
Analyze audio/dialogue	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐
Identify camera movement	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐⭐
Analyze visual composition	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐⭐⭐

Task	Gemini	Claude Code
Build detailed storyboard	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐
Generate structured JSON/shot lists	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐
Write scripts/tools to process video	⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐
Iterate on a large project/filesystem	⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐
Prompt engineering for image/video generation	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐

The important distinction is that **Gemini is actually designed to ingest and reason over video**. Google's current documentation says Gemini can process video, audio, timestamps and visual information; newer Gemini video processing can dynamically navigate the video rather than simply looking at fixed frames. Google AI for D… +2

Claude Code is much more interesting **after** you've extracted the video information. Its strength is acting as an agent over your local project/files, writing scripts, organizing assets, generating structured outputs, and iterating on a workflow. Claude Code itself does not currently have the same native video-analysis capability; a 2026 request for native video analysis was closed as not planned. GitHub

For your particular workflow

Based on the kind of AI-drama/storyboard work you've been doing, I would use:

Gemini → Claude Code → image/video generation

1. Gemini = Reverse engineer the source

Give Gemini the original 30–90 second video and ask it to produce something like:

```
VIDEO ANALYSIS

00:00–00:03
Scene: Rainy city park
Characters:
- Tiny Chihuahua
- Red raincoat

Action:
...

Camera:
- Medium wide shot
```

```
- Camera at dog eye level
- Slow push-in

Lighting:
- Overcast
- Cool blue-gray ambience
- Wet specular highlights

Emotion:
...

Environment:
...

Audio:
...

Transition:
Hard cut
```

Then have it produce a **shot-by-shot reconstruction**.

Gemini's video capabilities are particularly useful here because it can work from both visual and audio streams and reference timestamps. Google AI for ...

2. Claude Code = Turn the analysis into a production system

This is where I'd bring Claude Code in.

For example, give it the Gemini analysis and ask it to create:

```
project/
├── source/
│   └── original.mp4
├── analysis/
│   ├── scenes.json
│   ├── characters.json
│   ├── environments.json
│   └── audio.json
├── storyboard/
│   ├── shot-001.md
│   ├── shot-002.md
│   └── ...
├── prompts/
│   ├── image/
│   └── video/
└── assets/
```

Claude Code is excellent for turning this into an actual **repeatable pipeline**.

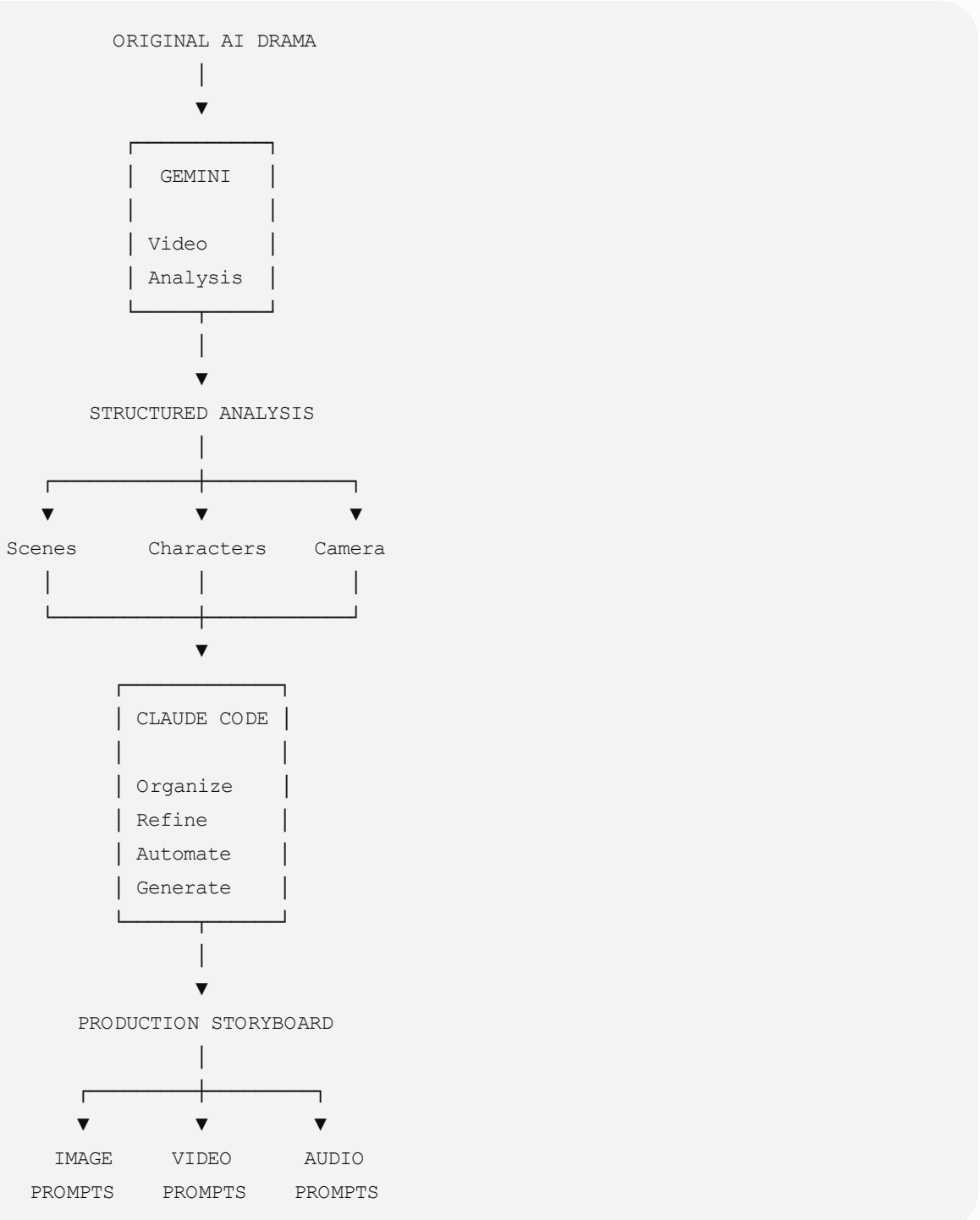
Gemini CLI also has strong coding/agent capabilities and can work with large context; Google's documentation currently recommends Pro models for complex, multi-stage tasks. GitHub

---

But there's an even better workflow

For what you're doing, I wouldn't choose **Claude Code OR Gemini**.

I'd use them for different jobs:



My ranking for your use case

For analyzing the actual video:

🥇 **Gemini**
🥈 Claude
🥉 Claude Code

For building an automated reverse-engineering workflow:

🥇 **Claude Code**
🥈 Gemini CLI
🥉 Gemini web/app

For producing the final detailed storyboard/prompt package:

🥇 **Gemini + Claude Code together**

One important caveat

For **very fast AI-drama edits**, don't rely exclusively on Gemini's default frame sampling. Google's documentation notes that standard processing samples video at **1 FPS**, which can miss rapid actions and quick cuts. Newer Gemini agentic video processing can dynamically inspect relevant portions of the timeline and is specifically intended to improve this kind of analysis. Google AI for D… +1

So if your videos contain things like:

> dog gets pushed → falls → discovers object → touches object → magical transformation → hero appears

I'd want the analysis to be **shot-level**, not merely "what happens every second."

Bottom line: Use Gemini to understand the video; use Claude Code to engineer the reverse-engineering workflow. For the specific AI-drama storyboard workflow you've been building, that's substantially better than trying to make Claude Code do the video understanding itself.

now give me step by step on how to reverse engineer a short AI drama

Yes. If the objective is **not merely to describe the video, but to reconstruct it closely enough that you could recreate the same short AI drama**, I would use a multi-pass workflow.

The key is: **do not ask an AI to "analyze this video" once and accept the result.** You want to progressively extract the video into increasingly precise production information.

Gemini is particularly suitable for the first stage because it can analyze video, audio, timestamps, and specific moments. Its current video tooling also supports agentic video analysis on newer Flash models, while static processing can be customized for higher frame rates when fast action matters. Google AI for D… +1

The complete workflow

```
ORIGINAL VIDEO
      ↓
1. Preserve / inspect source
      ↓
2. Extract technical metadata
      ↓
3. Gemini: story analysis
      ↓
4. Gemini: shot detection
      ↓
5. Gemini: individual shot analysis
      ↓
6. Extract keyframes
      ↓
7. Character Bible
      ↓
8. Environment Bible
      ↓
9. Camera & cinematography analysis
      ↓
10. Motion/action analysis
      ↓
11. Audio analysis
      ↓
12. Editing / pacing analysis
      ↓
13. Reconstruct screenplay
      ↓
14. Reconstruct storyboard
      ↓
15. Generate recreation prompts
      ↓
16. Generate images/video
      ↓
17. Compare recreation against original
```

```
      ↓
18. Iterate
```

I'll break down exactly what I would do.

STEP 1 — Get the original video

Start with the highest-quality version available.

Prefer:

```
original.mp4
```

rather than:

```
TikTok screen recording
compressed download
re-upload
watermarked version
```

You want to preserve:

- resolution
- frame rate
- audio
- timing
- cuts
- color
- motion blur
- original aspect ratio

For a typical AI drama:

```
Duration: 30–90 sec
Aspect: 9:16
FPS: 24/30/60
Resolution: 1080×1920
```

Don't modify it yet.

STEP 2 — Extract technical metadata

Before asking an AI anything, get the objective information.

For example:

```
Duration: 47.83 sec
Resolution: 1080 × 1920
FPS: 30
Audio: stereo
Codec: H.264
```

You can use FFmpeg/ffprobe for this.

You also want to determine:

```
total frames
average shot duration
number of cuts
audio duration
```

This gives you a technical baseline.

STEP 3 — First Gemini pass: understand the story

Now upload the **entire video to Gemini**.

Don't immediately ask for prompts.

Ask it to understand the story first.

Use a prompt approximately like:

```
Analyze this short AI drama as a professional film director and
screenplay analyst.

Do NOT generate prompts yet.

First reconstruct what the video is communicating.

Identify:

1. Main characters
2. Secondary characters
3. Character relationships
4. Setting
5. Beginning
6. Inciting incident
7. Conflict
8. Escalation
9. Turning point
```

```
10. Climax
11. Resolution
12. Emotional progression
13. Important objects
14. Cause-and-effect relationships
15. Any information communicated through visuals rather than dialogue

For every major event, provide timestamps.

Separate:
- what is directly visible
- what is heard
- what can reasonably be inferred

Do not invent information that cannot be supported by the video.
```

Gemini can explicitly reference moments using timestamps, which is useful for this process. Google AI for ...

Output

You want something like:

```
00:00–00:04
A small Chihuahua sits alone on a park bench during heavy rain.

00:04–00:08
A large Husky approaches.

00:08–00:11
The Husky pushes the Chihuahua into a muddy puddle.

00:11–00:15
The Chihuahua notices an antique lantern.

...
```

This is your **story skeleton**.

STEP 4 — Detect every shot

This is extremely important.

A scene and a shot are NOT the same thing.

For example:

```
SCENE 3 — Lantern

Shot 3A
Wide shot of Chihuahua near tree.

Shot 3B
Close-up of Chihuahua looking at lantern.

Shot 3C
Extreme close-up of paw touching lantern.

Shot 3D
Close-up of lantern illuminating.

Shot 3E
Wide shot revealing transformed character.
```

Ask Gemini:

```
Now perform a shot-by-shot segmentation of the video.

Identify EVERY camera shot and every visible cut.

For each shot provide:

- shot number
- start timestamp
- end timestamp
- duration
- what is visible
- characters visible
- character action
- important objects
- camera framing
- camera angle
- camera movement
- approximate lens perspective
- depth of field
- lighting
- color palette
- emotional purpose
- transition into next shot

Do not combine separate camera shots.
```

This is where you begin moving from **story analysis → cinematography analysis**.

STEP 5 — Create the shot table

Put everything into a structured table.

For example:

Shot	Time	Duration	Framing	Action
01	00:00–00:03	3s	Wide	Chihuahua alone
02	00:03–00:06	3s	Medium	Husky enters
03	00:06–00:08	2s	Close	Husky approaches
04	00:08–00:10	2s	Medium	Push
05	00:10–00:13	3s	Close	Chihuahua in puddle
06	00:13–00:16	3s	POV	Lantern
...	...	...	...	...

This becomes the **master shot list**.

STEP 6 — Extract keyframes yourself

This is one area where I would **not rely exclusively on Gemini**.

Extract frames around:

- beginning of every shot
- end of every shot
- major action
- character entrance
- character exit
- transformation
- emotional reaction
- important object reveal

For example:

```
frames/
├── shot_001_start.jpg
├── shot_001_end.jpg
├── shot_002_start.jpg
├── shot_002_end.jpg
```

```
├── shot_003_start.jpg
...
```

For fast action, extract additional frames.

This matters because Gemini's default static processing samples video at 1 FPS, which can miss rapid movement or quick cuts; Google's documentation specifically recommends higher/custom frame rates for such material. Google AI for ...

STEP 7 — Build the Character Bible

Now forget the story for a moment.

Analyze the **characters independently**.

For every recurring character:

```
CHARACTER: Chihuahua

Species:
Chihuahua

Sex:
Unknown / apparent

Age:
Puppy / adult

Body:
Small, delicate

Fur:
...

Face:
...

Eyes:
...

Ears:
...

Clothing:
Red raincoat

Accessories:
...
```

```
Proportions:
...

Personality:
...

Emotional baseline:
...

Movement:
...

Distinctive features:
...
```

Then analyze:

Front

Side

3/4

Back

Close-up

Full body

This is crucial for maintaining consistency when you later generate images.

STEP 8 — Build the Character State Sheet

AI dramas often change characters during the story.

So don't just create one description.

Create **states**.

Example:

```
CHIHUAHUA

STATE 01
Dry
Calm
Red raincoat
Sitting
```

```
STATE 02
Wet
Shivering
Sad
Raincoat soaked

STATE 03
Fearful
Looking at lantern

STATE 04
Hopeful
Illuminated by golden light

STATE 05
After transformation
...
```

This is much more useful than a generic character description.

STEP 9 — Build the Environment Bible

Now analyze locations.

For example:

```
LOCATION 01 — PARK

Time:
Night / evening

Weather:
Heavy rain

Ground:
Wet pavement + mud

Trees:
...

Bench:
...

Lighting:
Cool ambient light

Background:
...
```

```
Atmosphere:
Moody / lonely

Color palette:
Blue-gray + muted greens

Important props:
Lantern
Bench
Tree
Puddle
```

Then identify **continuity anchors**.

For example:

```
Tree = always screen-left
Bench = center background
Lantern = near tree root
Puddle = foreground-right
```

These details help you reproduce shots consistently.

STEP 10 — Analyze cinematography

This is where your reverse engineering becomes much more sophisticated.

For every shot, determine:

Composition

```
subject position
negative space
foreground
midground
background
symmetry
leading lines
rule of thirds
```

Camera

```
wide
medium-wide
medium
medium-close
```

```
close-up
extreme close-up
```

Angle

```
eye level
low angle
high angle
overhead
ground level
```

Movement

```
static
pan
tilt
dolly in
dolly out
tracking
handheld
crane
orbit
```

Lens character

You won't know the exact lens, so describe it approximately:

```
wide-angle perspective
normal perspective
telephoto compression
strong foreground exaggeration
shallow cinematic perspective
```

Don't pretend you know "35mm" when the source doesn't allow that determination.

Say:

> approximate 35–50mm equivalent perspective

rather than claiming an exact lens.

STEP 11 — Analyze lighting

For each shot:

```
KEY LIGHT
FILL
RIM
PRACTICALS
AMBIENT
COLOR TEMPERATURE
CONTRAST
SHADOW QUALITY
HIGHLIGHTS
```

For example:

```
Key:
Soft cool overcast sky

Practical:
Warm lantern

Contrast:
High

Background:
Cool blue-gray

Subject:
Warm highlights from lantern

Result:
Warm/cool emotional contrast
```

That **warm lantern vs cold rain** relationship might be one of the visual storytelling mechanisms of the entire film.

STEP 12 — Analyze character movement

Don't just say:

> "The Husky pushes the Chihuahua."

Break the motion down.

```
00:08.0
Husky raises right arm.

00:08.4
Arm extends.
```

```
00:08.7
Hand/paw contacts Chihuahua.

00:09.0
Chihuahua begins falling.

00:09.4
Body rotates.

00:09.8
Chihuahua hits puddle.

00:10.1
Water splashes.
```

For AI video recreation, this level of decomposition is extremely valuable.

You're essentially converting:

video → motion choreography

STEP 13 — Analyze facial expressions

For each important emotional beat:

```
eyes
eyebrows
mouth
head angle
ears
body posture
gaze direction
```

For example:

```
BEFORE PUSH

Eyes:
Looking upward toward Husky

Head:
Slightly raised

Body:
Defensive / tense

AFTER PUSH

Eyes:
```

```
Wide

Head:
Tilted downward

Body:
Collapsed

Emotion:
Shock → humiliation → sadness
```

This is particularly important for AI-generated animal dramas because **emotion is often communicated almost entirely through exaggerated facial/body acting**.

STEP 14 — Analyze audio

Treat audio as its own layer.

Extract:

Dialogue

Exact wording.

Voice

```
male/female
age
pitch
accent
speed
emotion
```

Music

```
genre
tempo
instrumentation
emotional progression
```

Sound effects

```
rain
footsteps
impact
splash
```

```
magical sound
wind
animal vocalization
```

Audio timing

For example:

```
00:00 rain begins
00:05 music enters
00:09 impact sound
00:10 music drops
00:14 magical hum
00:16 crescendo
```

This allows you to reconstruct the **sound design**, not just the visuals.

STEP 15 — Analyze editing

Now ask:

> Why did the editor cut here?

For every cut:

```
Shot A → Shot B

Reason:
action continuation / reaction / reveal / escalation / emphasis
```

Look for:

- match cuts
- reaction cuts
- action cuts
- reveal cuts
- punch-in cuts
- dramatic pauses
- speed ramps
- slow motion
- transitions

Then calculate:

```
average shot duration
fastest shot
```

```
longest shot
number of shots
shots per 10 seconds
```

This tells you the **editing rhythm**.

STEP 16 — Reconstruct the screenplay

Now convert all of the analysis back into a screenplay.

Not a generic summary.

Something like:

```
SCENE 01 — EXT. PARK — NIGHT

Heavy rain falls over an empty city park.

A tiny Chihuahua sits alone on a bench,
wearing a bright red raincoat.

She shivers.

CUT TO:

A large Husky enters the frame.

He walks toward her.

The Chihuahua looks up.

...
```

The screenplay should include:

```
ACTION
DIALOGUE
EMOTION
SOUND
CAMERA-RELEVANT EVENTS
```

STEP 17 — Reconstruct the storyboard

Now each shot gets a production card.

For example:

```
SHOT 07

Duration:
2.4 sec

Shot type:
Medium close-up

Camera:
Low eye-level

Composition:
Chihuahua occupies lower-left third.

Action:
She notices the lantern.

Expression:
Eyes widen.

Lighting:
Cool rain ambience + warm lantern glow.

Environment:
Wet park, tree trunk behind subject.

Camera:
Slow push-in.

Sound:
Rain + subtle magical hum.

Transition:
Cut from previous reaction shot.
```

This is essentially what you were asking for in your previous storyboard work.

STEP 18 — Create the recreation prompt

Only **now** should you generate the image/video prompt.

Don't make the prompt from the original video directly.

Instead:

```
SOURCE VIDEO
     ↓
ANALYSIS
     ↓
SHOT SPECIFICATION
     ↓
GENERATION PROMPT
```

For example:

```
Ultra-realistic cinematic scene of a tiny Chihuahua
wearing a soaked red raincoat, sitting beside an antique
brass lantern at the base of a large tree in a rain-soaked
city park at night...

Camera:
low eye-level medium close-up,
slightly compressed perspective,
shallow depth of field...

Lighting:
cold blue-gray rainy ambience contrasted by warm golden
lantern illumination...

Expression:
frightened but hopeful...

Environment:
wet pavement, muddy puddles, rain streaks...
```

STEP 19 — Separate IMAGE prompts from VIDEO prompts

This is important.

An **image prompt** describes:

> what the frame looks like.

A **video prompt** describes:

> what changes over time.

Image

```
Chihuahua looking toward the glowing lantern...
```

Video

```
The Chihuahua slowly raises her head and turns toward
the lantern. Her ears lift slightly. Rain continues falling.
The camera slowly pushes forward while the lantern's golden
light gradually intensifies...
```

Don't try to make one prompt do both jobs.

STEP 20 — Recreate the first shot

Don't generate the entire 60-second drama immediately.

Generate:

Shot 01 only.

Compare it against the original.

Evaluate:

```
Character ————————— 90%
Environment ———————— 85%
Composition ———————— 80%
Lighting ——————————— 90%
Camera ————————————— 75%
Emotion ————————————— 85%
```

Then fix the prompt.

STEP 21 — Establish reference images

Once you have the correct character design, create a **master reference**.

For example:

```
CHARACTER_REFERENCE/
    chihuahua_master.png
    husky_master.png
    pitbull_master.png
```

Then use those references throughout the remaining shots.

Same for environments:

```
ENVIRONMENT_REFERENCE/
    rainy_park.png
    alley.png
    house.png
```

This dramatically reduces character/environment drift.

STEP 22 — Recreate shot-by-shot

Now work sequentially:

```
Shot 01 ✓
Shot 02 ✓
Shot 03 ✓
Shot 04 ✓
Shot 05 ✓
...
```

Don't move forward if a major continuity problem exists.

For example:

❌ Shot 1 Chihuahua has short ears
❌ Shot 2 Chihuahua has long ears

Fix Shot 2 before continuing.

STEP 23 — Assemble the recreation

Once all shots exist:

```
shot_001.mp4
shot_002.mp4
shot_003.mp4
...
```

Assemble them according to the **original timing**.

The goal initially isn't:

> "Make a better video."

It's:

> **"Match the source video."**

That distinction is extremely important.

STEP 24 — Compare side-by-side

Create:

```
ORIGINAL        RECREATION
————————        ——————————
Shot 01         Shot 01
Shot 02         Shot 02
Shot 03         Shot 03
...
```

Compare:

Story

Does the same thing happen?

Timing

Does it happen at the same moment?

Composition

Is the subject in the same place?

Character

Does the character look consistent?

Camera

Does the camera move similarly?

Lighting

Does the emotional lighting match?

Motion

Does the action happen at the same speed?

Audio

Do important sounds happen at the same time?

STEP 25 — Iterate using a discrepancy list

Instead of saying:

> "It doesn't look right."

Create:

```
SHOT 04 DISCREPANCIES

1. Husky is too close to Chihuahua.
2. Camera is 15–20° too high.
3. Chihuahua needs stronger fearful expression.
4. Background tree is missing.
5. Rain needs greater density.
6. Push occurs too slowly.
7. Impact happens 0.4 sec too late.
```

Then fix only those things.

This is much more efficient.

The ideal AI division

For your workflow, I'd divide the tools like this:

Gemini

Video intelligence

```
video
 ↓
story
 ↓
shots
 ↓
characters
 ↓
camera
 ↓
lighting
 ↓
```

```
motion
 ↓
audio
```

Gemini can process video and answer timestamp-specific questions, and current Gemini Flash models support agentic video exploration as well as configurable static sampling.

Google AI for D… +1

Claude Code

Production intelligence

```
analysis
 ↓
JSON
 ↓
project files
 ↓
storyboard
 ↓
prompt library
 ↓
generation pipeline
 ↓
comparison tools
 ↓
iteration
```

I'd actually create a project like:

```
ai-drama-reverse-engineering/

├── source/
│   └── original.mp4
│
├── analysis/
│   ├── technical.json
│   ├── story.md
│   ├── shots.json
│   ├── characters.json
│   ├── environments.json
│   ├── cinematography.json
│   ├── motion.json
│   ├── audio.json
│   └── editing.json
│
├── references/
│   ├── characters/
│   ├── environments/
│   └── props/
│
```

```
├── storyboard/
│   ├── 001.md
│   ├── 002.md
│   ├── 003.md
│   └── ...
│
├── prompts/
│   ├── image/
│   └── video/
│
├── generated/
│   ├── images/
│   └── videos/
│
└── final/
    └── recreation.mp4
```

That is the structure I would recommend if you're planning to do this **repeatedly**, rather than reverse-engineering just one video.

The most important principle

Don't think of the process as:

> **Video → AI prompt**

Think of it as:

> **Video → Evidence → Structured analysis → Shot specification → Prompt → Recreation → Comparison → Correction**

That extra structure is what will make the recreated AI drama much closer to the original.

And for **very short AI dramas with lots of rapid cuts**, I'd add one extra stage between Gemini and the storyboard: **automated frame extraction at every cut + dense extraction around action beats**. Gemini's documentation explicitly notes that 1-FPS processing can miss fast action, so this is one of the places where a local FFmpeg/Python pipeline can complement Gemini rather than relying on the model alone. Google AI for …

this is different steps from earlier

You're right. I gave you a **more exhaustive filmmaking workflow**, rather than keeping the same practical workflow we were building earlier.

The earlier approach was closer to:

Video → Gemini analysis → extract scenes/shots → character consistency → storyboard → generation prompts → recreate

The new answer added technical metadata, audio engineering, cinematography measurements, discrepancy scoring, etc. Those are useful, but they changed the workflow instead of extending it.

For your specific goal—**reverse-engineering short viral AI drama videos so you can recreate them**—I'd keep the workflow much simpler:

The workflow I'd actually recommend

1. Analyze the entire video with Gemini

- Understand the story
- Identify characters
- Identify locations
- Identify the emotional arc
- Identify important objects

↓

2. Break the video into scenes

- Scene 1
- Scene 2
- Scene 3
- etc.

↓

3. Break each scene into individual shots

- exact timestamps
- shot composition
- character action
- camera
- environment
- emotion

↓

4. Create Character Sheets

- appearance
- clothing
- proportions

- facial features
- personality
- emotional states

↓

5. Create Environment Sheets

- location
- weather
- time of day
- lighting
- important props
- visual style

↓

6. Create the Master Storyboard

One panel per shot, with:

- reference frame
- shot description
- character action
- camera
- lighting
- emotion
- duration

↓

7. Create image-generation prompts

One prompt for each storyboard shot.

↓

8. Create video-generation prompts

Describe the movement between the beginning and ending frame.

↓

9. Generate the shots

Keep character/environment references consistent.

↓

10. Edit everything together
Match the original:

- shot duration
- cuts
- pacing
- music
- SFX
- dialogue

↓

11. Compare against the original
Fix the biggest visual/continuity differences.

And the tool division stays:

Stage	Tool
Understand original video	**Gemini**
Scene/shot analysis	**Gemini**
Character/environment analysis	**Gemini**
Storyboard structure	**Claude Code**
Organize analysis/files	**Claude Code**
Generate prompt system	**Claude Code**
Generate images/video	Your chosen generation model
Final editing	Premiere / DaVinci / CapCut etc.

So **Gemini is the eyes**, while **Claude Code is the production assistant/automation layer**.

I would **not** start with FFmpeg, metadata extraction, audio engineering, or complicated scoring. Those should only be added later if you discover that your basic reverse-engineering process is missing something.

If you want, I can give you the **exact 10-step workflow we should use from now on**, including the **specific Gemini prompts for each step**, so you can take any 30–60

second AI drama and run the same process every time.

which is better you or claude on giving this kind of instructions like “step by step guide on how to reverse engineering ai videos”

For **this specific task**, I would choose **me (GPT-5.6 Luna)** over Claude.

Not because one model is universally better, but because your task is not just "give me steps." You're building a **repeatable reverse-engineering workflow for short AI drama videos**, and that requires maintaining the workflow across multiple iterations.

My comparison

Capability	Me	Claude
Step-by-step workflow design	**9.5/10**	9/10
Maintaining your intended workflow	**9.5/10**	9/10
Breaking AI videos into scenes/shots	**9.5/10**	9/10
Story/character analysis	**9.5/10**	9.5/10
Cinematography analysis	**9.5/10**	9.5/10
Creating reusable prompt frameworks	**9.5/10**	9.5/10
Turning workflow into code/tools	9/10	**10/10**
Large coding projects	9/10	**10/10**
Keeping a complex production workflow organized	**9.5/10**	9.5/10
Visual storyboard generation	**10/10**	9/10
Iterative visual direction	**10/10**	9/10

The distinction I'd make

Ask me:

> "Design the methodology."

I can help determine:

```
What should we analyze?
        ↓
In what order?
        ↓
What should the output of each step be?
        ↓
What information carries into the next step?
        ↓
How do we turn it into a recreation?
```

Ask Claude Code:

> "Build this methodology."

That's where Claude Code becomes particularly useful.

For example:

```
You have 50 videos.

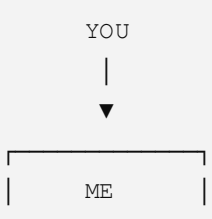
Build me a tool that:

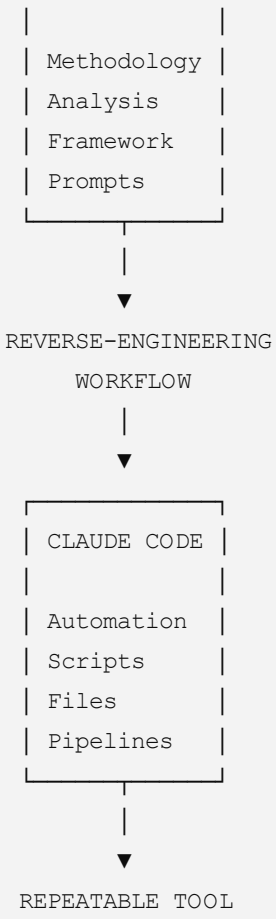
1. accepts an MP4
2. extracts frames
3. detects cuts
4. organizes frames
5. creates JSON
6. generates analysis files
7. creates storyboard markdown
8. generates prompt templates
9. keeps everything in a project folder
```

Claude Code is excellent for implementing that kind of filesystem/code-heavy workflow.

For your project, I'd actually use both

I'd make **me the workflow architect** and **Claude Code the implementation engineer**.





One correction to my previous answer

You caught an important issue: **I shouldn't keep changing the methodology every time you ask for more detail.**

For this project, we should establish **one canonical reverse-engineering workflow** first.

Then everything else—Gemini prompts, Claude Code instructions, scripts, storyboard templates, character sheets, generation prompts—should be built **around that workflow**, rather than inventing a new workflow each time.

So if you're going to continue this project with me, I'd recommend we do the next step as:

> **"Create the definitive workflow for reverse-engineering a 30–90 second AI drama video, with exactly what goes in and comes out of every step."**

Once we lock that down, we don't change the architecture unless there's a specific reason.

what gpt are you using now in this chat

I'm **GPT-5.6 Luna**.

these are the steps prompt you give earlier

1. Analyze this entire short drama from beginning to end. Your first task is to reverse engineer the STORY STRUCTURE, not critique it.

Create a chronological timeline using timestamps.

For each scene, identify:

Start and end timestamp

Show more

Yes. **These are the steps we should use as the canonical workflow.** They are substantially better aligned with your goal than the expanded workflow I gave you afterward.

Your original sequence has a good progression:

1. **Story structure**
2. **Scene construction**
3. **Visual filmmaking**
4. **Editing**
5. **Dialogue**
6. **Reusable storytelling blueprint**
7. **Then presumably generation/reconstruction**

The important thing is that **Step 7 should not duplicate the earlier analysis**. It should take everything extracted in Steps 1–6 and turn it into the actual **recreation package**.

I would preserve Steps **1–6 almost exactly as you wrote them**.

I would make Step 7:

7. Convert the reverse-engineered blueprint into a production-ready recreation plan.

For every scene/shot, generate:

- Shot number
- Timestamp
- Duration

- Story purpose
- Character(s)
- Character appearance/state
- Character action
- Facial expression
- Body language
- Environment
- Important props
- Composition
- Shot size
- Camera angle
- Camera movement
- Lighting
- Color palette
- Depth of field
- Atmosphere
- Audio/SFX
- Dialogue, if applicable
- Transition
- Emotional objective

Then create **three outputs**:

A. Character Bible

A locked description for every recurring character, including:

- physical appearance
- proportions
- clothing
- colors
- distinctive features
- personality
- emotional states
- consistency rules

B. Scene/Environment Bible

For every recurring location:

- architecture/environment
- time of day
- weather
- lighting

- color palette
- props
- atmosphere
- continuity rules

C. Shot-by-Shot Generation Plan

For every shot:

> **Image prompt → starting frame**

and

> **Video prompt → movement from starting frame to ending frame**

This is where we transition from **reverse engineering** into **recreation**.

So the definitive architecture becomes:

```
1. STORY STRUCTURE
        ↓
2. SCENE CONSTRUCTION
        ↓
3. VISUAL FILMMAKING
        ↓
4. EDITING STRATEGY
        ↓
5. DIALOGUE
        ↓
6. REUSABLE STORY BLUEPRINT
        ↓
7. PRODUCTION-READY RECREATION PLAN
        ↓
8. CHARACTER BIBLE
        ↓
9. ENVIRONMENT BIBLE
        ↓
10. SHOT-BY-SHOT IMAGE PROMPTS
        ↓
11. SHOT-BY-SHOT VIDEO PROMPTS
        ↓
12. GENERATE + EDIT + COMPARE
```

And there's an important distinction in **Step 6**:

> **Step 6 is for understanding the formula, not copying the original.**

That's the part that lets you take something like:

> weak character → humiliation → discovery → supernatural intervention → transformation → revenge/resolution

and turn it into a **new story using the same dramatic mechanics** without reproducing the original characters, dialogue, or distinctive events.

So yes: **keep the original 1–6. Don't replace them with my expanded technical workflow.** My previous answer overcomplicated the process.

can we remove:

Then create a completely ORIGINAL example using the same high-level structural principles but with:
different characters
different setting
different conflict
different events
different dialogue
different ending details
The purpose is to understand the storytelling mechanics,

Show more

Yes. I'd remove that section from **Step 6**.

Step 6 should focus purely on extracting the reusable storytelling blueprint from the analyzed video, without generating a new example.

Revised Step 6

6. Using everything observed, reconstruct the underlying storytelling blueprint.

Do NOT copy the story, characters, dialogue, distinctive creative elements, or specific events.

Extract the reusable storytelling structure:

- Hook formula
- Character setup formula
- Conflict formula
- Escalation pattern

- Emotional progression
- Scene progression
- Revelation/twist mechanism
- Climax structure
- Ending structure
- Pacing pattern

Then summarize the **underlying storytelling formula** in a concise, reusable format that can be applied when developing a new story.

This keeps Step 6 focused on **reverse engineering the mechanics**, rather than asking Gemini to generate another story.

Today 9:58 AM

can you summarize what we've tackled so far

Yes. Here's the current state of what we've worked out.

1. Main objective

You're building a workflow for **reverse engineering short AI drama videos** so you can understand how they are constructed and then use the extracted storytelling/filmmaking principles to create your own original videos.

The focus is **not simply summarizing the video**. The goal is to understand:

- Story structure
- Scene construction
- Visual filmmaking
- Editing
- Dialogue
- Pacing
- Emotional progression
- Reusable storytelling patterns
- Eventually, how to turn that analysis into production-ready prompts

---

2. Tool choice

We compared **Gemini vs Claude Code** for this workflow.

The conclusion was:

Gemini → video analysis

Best suited for analyzing the original video because it can work directly with:

- Video
- Audio
- Timestamps
- Individual moments
- Visual sequences
- Dialogue
- Temporal relationships

So Gemini is essentially the **video-analysis/observation layer**.

Claude Code → implementation/automation

Better suited for:

- Building scripts
- Managing files
- Creating automated pipelines
- Organizing analysis outputs
- Generating prompt files
- Automating repetitive production tasks

So Claude Code is more of the **production/automation layer**.

GPT-5.6 Luna → methodology

We also discussed whether I or Claude would be better at designing the actual methodology.

The distinction we settled on was:

GPT-5.6 Luna → workflow/methodology design
Gemini → original video analysis
Claude Code → automation and implementation

---

3. Your canonical reverse-engineering workflow

You had an earlier workflow that you specifically wanted to preserve because some of my later versions became unnecessarily elaborate.

We therefore established that **your original Steps 1–6 are the canonical foundation**.

Step 1 — Story Structure

Analyze the entire short drama from beginning to end.

Determine:

- Chronological timeline
- Scenes
- Locations
- Characters
- Events
- Information revealed
- Changes within each scene
- Emotional states
- Scene purpose
- Why the audience continues watching

Then identify:

- Opening hook
- Protagonist
- Initial situation
- Central conflict
- Inciting incident
- Major complications
- Midpoint/revelation
- Escalation
- Climax
- Resolution
- Final emotional beat

Important constraint:

> Don't invent information that isn't observable or reasonably inferable. Use timestamps.

Step 2 — Scene Construction

Reverse engineer every scene like a screenwriter.

For each scene:

- Scene objective
- Who wants what?
- What prevents them?
- Source of conflict

- Information revealed
- Information withheld
- Emotional starting point
- Emotional ending point
- Turning point
- Stakes
- Why the audience should care
- Why the scene ends where it does
- How it sets up the next scene

Also classify the scene's primary function:

- Establishing information
- Tension
- Character reveal
- Mystery
- Escalation
- Emotional relief
- Twist
- Later payoff
- Resolution

And ask:

> What would be lost if this scene were removed?

Step 3 — Visual Filmmaking

Reverse engineer the visual language shot-by-shot where practical.

Analyze:

- Shot size
- Camera angle
- Camera movement
- Composition
- Subject positioning
- Lighting
- Color
- Background
- Props
- Facial expressions

- Body language
- Depth of field
- Visual emphasis
- What the camera wants the audience to notice

Then identify recurring visual patterns involving:

- Emotional close-ups
- Wide shots
- Camera movement
- Tension
- Lighting
- Mood
- Color storytelling
- Visual foreshadowing
- Visual symbolism

The important part is:

> Don't merely describe the shot. Explain **why the filmmaker likely made that choice**.

Step 4 — Editing Strategy

Analyze how the video is assembled.

Look at:

- Average shot duration
- Cut points
- Reasons for cuts
- Reaction shots
- Shot/reverse-shot
- Cross-cutting
- Jump cuts
- Match cuts
- Transitions
- Pacing
- Silence
- Music
- SFX

Identify where editing increases:

- Curiosity

- Tension
- Emotional impact
- Surprise
- Urgency

Then create a timeline showing how pacing changes from beginning → end.

The final goal is to explain the pacing strategy in a way that another filmmaker can reproduce the **same type of pacing**, without copying the original.

Step 5 — Dialogue

Analyze important dialogue exchanges.

For each:

- Timestamp
- Speaker
- Literal words
- Apparent meaning
- What they want
- Information revealed
- Information concealed
- Emotional subtext
- Power dynamic
- How the exchange changes the situation

Identify:

- Exposition
- Conflict
- Subtext
- Foreshadowing
- Manipulation
- Emotional confrontation
- Revelations
- Callbacks
- Repeated phrases

And determine how dialogue actually **moves the story forward**.

Important constraint:

> Don't invent dialogue. If something is unclear, mark it as uncertain.

---

4. Step 6 — Story Blueprint

This is the part we just refined.

The purpose is to take everything from Steps 1–5 and reconstruct the **underlying storytelling blueprint**.

The current version is:

> **6. Using everything observed, reconstruct the underlying storytelling blueprint.**

Do **not** copy:

- Story
- Characters
- Dialogue
- Distinctive creative elements
- Specific events

Instead extract:

- Hook formula
- Character setup formula
- Conflict formula
- Escalation pattern
- Emotional progression
- Scene progression
- Revelation/twist mechanism
- Climax structure
- Ending structure
- Pacing pattern

Then summarize the **underlying storytelling formula** in a concise, reusable format that can be applied when developing a new story.

We explicitly removed this part:

> “Then create a completely ORIGINAL example…”

You decided that this was unnecessary.

That's a good change because Step 6 is supposed to be **analysis/extraction**, not another creative-writing exercise.

---

5. What comes after the analysis

We then discussed extending the workflow beyond the six reverse-engineering steps.

The proposed production pipeline was:

7. Production-Ready Recreation Plan

Turn the findings from Steps 1–6 into a structured production plan.

For each shot/sequence:

- Shot number
- Timestamp
- Duration
- Story purpose
- Characters
- Character appearance/state
- Character action
- Facial expression
- Body language
- Environment
- Important props
- Composition
- Shot size
- Camera angle
- Camera movement
- Lighting
- Color palette
- Depth of field
- Atmosphere
- Audio/SFX
- Dialogue
- Transition
- Emotional objective

---

8. Character Bible

Establish consistent visual specifications for every recurring character.

For example:

- Species/person
- Age
- Body type
- Face
- Fur/skin
- Clothing
- Accessories
- Colors
- Distinguishing features
- Emotional baseline
- Character behavior

This becomes the reference for image/video generation.

---

9. Environment / Location Bible

Define recurring environments.

For example:

- Location
- Architecture
- Layout
- Materials
- Props
- Lighting
- Weather
- Time of day
- Color palette
- Atmosphere
- Spatial relationships

This is intended to maintain visual consistency between shots.

---

10. Shot-by-Shot Image Prompts

Convert each shot into an image-generation prompt.

The image prompt primarily establishes the **starting visual frame**:

- Character appearance
- Pose
- Expression
- Environment
- Composition
- Camera
- Lighting
- Visual style
- Important props

---

11. Shot-by-Shot Video Prompts

Then describe what happens **from the starting frame to the ending frame**.

The video prompt focuses on:

- Character movement
- Facial changes
- Body movement
- Camera movement
- Environmental movement
- Interaction
- Timing
- Emotional progression

So the conceptual distinction is:

Image prompt = what the shot looks like

Video prompt = what happens during the shot

---

12. Generate → Edit → Compare → Iterate

Finally:

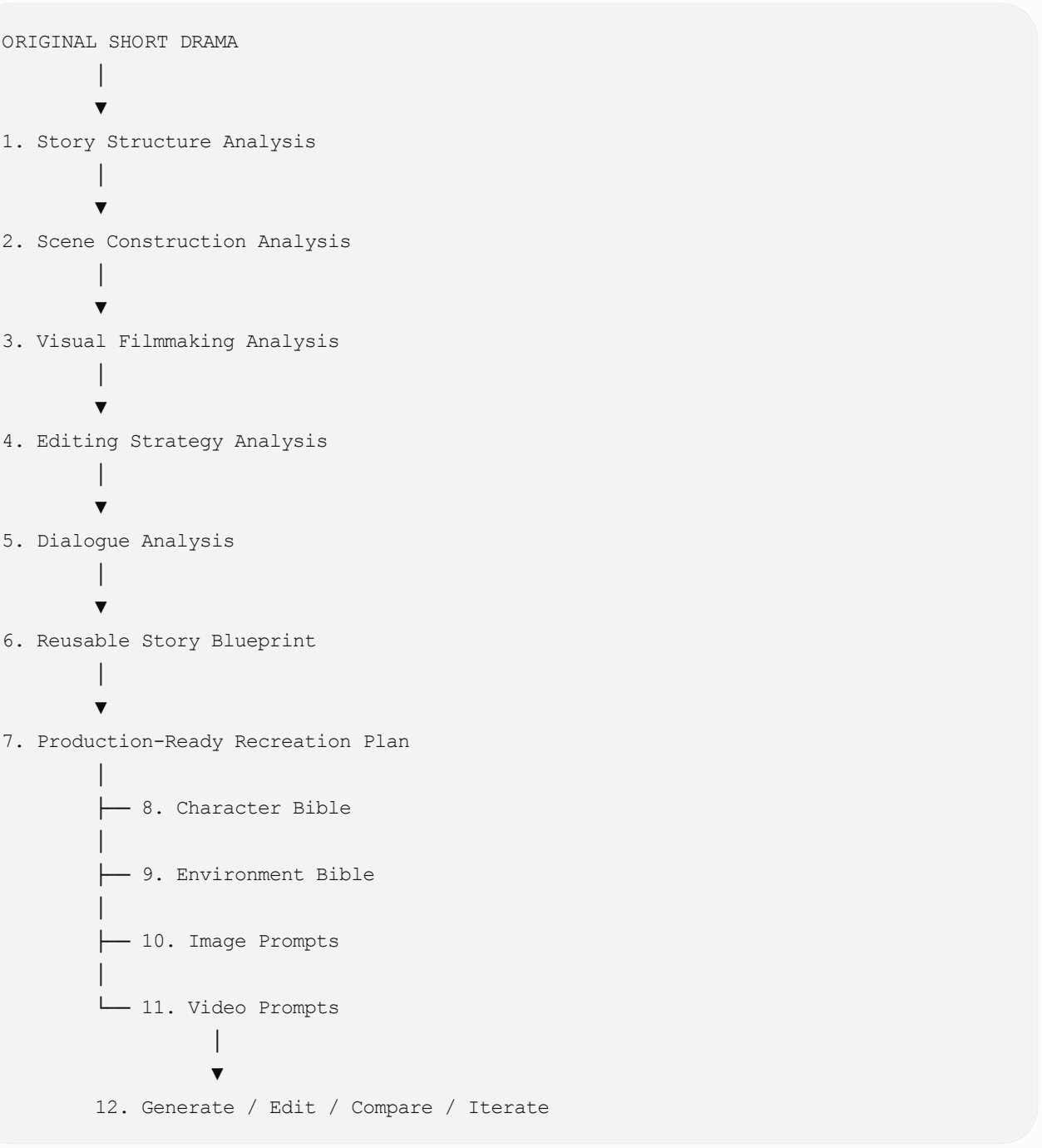
1. Generate shots
2. Assemble them
3. Compare against the reverse-engineered structure
4. Identify discrepancies
5. Fix prompts/generation

6. Re-edit
7. Repeat

---

6. The overall architecture

So the workflow we've converged on is:



The key principle

The most important distinction we've established is:

Steps 1–6 = reverse engineering

Steps 7–12 = production

That keeps the process clean. We first understand **how the original works**, then translate those findings into a production system for creating an original video.

rewrite put the prompts inside a code block for easy copy paste

Below is the cleaned-up version of the workflow, with each prompt separated into a copy-paste-ready code block.

1. Story Structure Analysis

```
Analyze this entire short drama from beginning to end.

Your first task is to reverse engineer the STORY STRUCTURE, not critique the video.

Create a chronological timeline with timestamps.

For each scene, identify:
- Start timestamp
- End timestamp
- Location
- Characters present
- What happens
- What information the audience learns
- What changes during the scene
- Emotional state of each important character
- Purpose of the scene
- How the scene creates a reason to continue watching

Then identify:
- Opening hook
- Protagonist
- Protagonist's initial situation
- Central conflict
- Inciting incident
- Major complications
- Midpoint or major revelation
- Escalation
- Climax
- Resolution
- Final emotional beat

Do not invent information that is not observable or reasonably inferred from the vi

Use timestamps throughout your analysis.
```

2. Scene Construction Analysis

```
Reverse engineer every scene as a screenwriter studying how this short drama was cc

For each scene, analyze:

- Timestamp
- Scene objective
- Who wants what?
- Who or what prevents them from getting it?
- Source of conflict
- Information revealed
- Information withheld
- Emotional starting point
- Emotional ending point
- Turning point
- Stakes
- Why the audience should care
- Why the scene ends where it does
- How the scene sets up the next scene

Then identify the primary function of each scene:

- Establishing information
- Tension
- Character reveal
- Mystery
- Escalation
- Emotional relief
- Twist
- Later payoff
- Resolution

Finally, answer:

What would be lost if each scene were removed?

Focus on understanding how each scene contributes to the overall story rather than
```

3. Visual Filmmaking Analysis

```
Reverse engineer the visual filmmaking of this short drama shot-by-shot where pract

For each important shot or sequence, analyze:

- Timestamp
```

```
- Shot size
- Camera angle
- Camera movement
- Composition
- Subject positioning
- Lighting
- Color
- Background
- Props
- Facial expressions
- Body language
- Depth of field
- Visual emphasis
- What the camera wants the audience to notice

Do not merely describe what is visible.

Explain WHY each visual choice appears to have been made and what effect it has on

Then identify recurring visual patterns:

- Shot selection during emotional moments
- Use of close-ups
- Use of wide shots
- Camera movement and tension
- Lighting and mood
- Color storytelling
- Visual foreshadowing
- Visual symbolism

Focus on the filmmaking decisions and their narrative purpose.
```

---

4. Editing Strategy Analysis

```
Reverse engineer the editing strategy of this short drama.

Analyze:

- Average shot duration
- Where cuts happen
- Why cuts happen
- Reaction shots
- Shot/reverse-shot
- Cross-cutting
- Jump cuts
- Match cuts
- Transitions
- Pacing
- Silence
```

```
- Music
- Sound effects

Identify the specific moments where editing increases:

- Curiosity
- Tension
- Emotional impact
- Surprise
- Urgency

Create a timeline showing how the pacing changes from the beginning to the end.

Explain the editing strategy in simple, practical terms so another filmmaker could

Focus on the underlying editing principles rather than merely describing the cuts.
```

---

5. Dialogue Analysis

```
Analyze the dialogue in this short drama.

For each important exchange, identify:

- Timestamp
- Speaker
- Literal words
- Apparent meaning
- What the speaker wants from the other person
- Information revealed
- Information concealed
- Emotional subtext
- Power dynamic
- How the exchange changes the situation

Identify examples of:

- Exposition
- Conflict
- Subtext
- Foreshadowing
- Manipulation
- Emotional confrontation
- Revelations
- Callbacks
- Repeated phrases

Explain how the dialogue moves the story forward rather than functioning as simple

Do not invent dialogue.
```

If dialogue is unclear or inaudible, mark it as uncertain rather than guessing

---

6. Reusable Story Blueprint

```
Using everything observed in the previous analyses, reconstruct the underlying stor

Do NOT copy:
- The story
- Characters
- Dialogue
- Distinctive creative elements
- Specific events

Instead, extract the reusable storytelling structure.

Analyze:

- Hook formula
- Character setup formula
- Conflict formula
- Escalation pattern
- Emotional progression
- Scene progression
- Revelation or twist mechanism
- Climax structure
- Ending structure
- Pacing pattern

Then summarize the underlying storytelling formula in a concise, reusable format th

The purpose is to understand the storytelling mechanics and structural principles h
```

---

7. Production-Ready Recreation Plan

```
Using the results from Steps 1–6, convert the reverse-engineered findings into a pr

For every scene and important shot, define:

- Shot number
- Scene number
- Timestamp
- Estimated duration
- Story purpose
- Characters present
- Character appearance/state
```

```
- Character action
- Facial expression
- Body language
- Environment
- Important props
- Composition
- Shot size
- Camera angle
- Camera movement
- Lighting
- Color palette
- Depth of field
- Atmosphere
- Audio/SFX
- Dialogue, if applicable
- Transition
- Emotional objective

The goal is to create a precise visual production plan that can later be converted

Maintain character, environment, spatial, lighting, and visual continuity between s
```

---

8. Character Bible

```
Using the production plan and visual analysis, create a Character Bible for every i

For each character, define:

- Character name
- Species/type
- Age
- Gender, if visually identifiable
- Body proportions
- Height/build
- Face/head shape
- Eyes
- Hair/fur
- Skin/fur color
- Distinctive physical features
- Clothing
- Shoes
- Accessories
- Important props
- Color palette
- Typical facial expressions
- Body language
- Emotional baseline
- Character behavior
- Relationship to other characters
```

```
Separate permanent character traits from scene-specific changes.

The Character Bible must be detailed enough to maintain consistent character appear
```

---

9. Environment / Location Bible

```
Create an Environment and Location Bible for every important location in the story.

For each location, define:

- Location name
- Overall visual description
- Architecture or natural environment
- Spatial layout
- Important objects
- Props
- Materials and textures
- Background elements
- Foreground elements
- Lighting
- Time of day
- Weather
- Color palette
- Atmosphere
- Depth and spatial relationships
- Recurring visual elements

Identify which elements must remain consistent between shots.

The goal is to maintain strong environment and spatial continuity across all AI-ger
```

---

10. Shot-by-Shot Image Prompts

```
Using the Character Bible, Environment Bible, and Production-Ready Shot Plan, creat

Each image prompt must describe the STARTING FRAME of the shot.

Include:

- Character identity and appearance
- Character clothing
- Character pose
- Facial expression
- Body language
```

```
- Character position
- Environment
- Important props
- Composition
- Shot size
- Camera angle
- Lens/look
- Depth of field
- Lighting
- Color palette
- Atmosphere
- Visual emphasis
- Cinematic realism
- Important continuity details

The generated image should function as the visual starting frame for the correspond

Maintain strict consistency with the Character Bible and Environment Bible.

Do not introduce new character traits, props, locations, or visual details that cor
```

---

11. Shot-by-Shot Video Prompts

```
Using the corresponding starting-frame image, Character Bible, Environment Bible, a

Describe what happens FROM the starting frame TO the ending frame.

Include:

- Character movement
- Facial expression changes
- Body movement
- Interaction between characters
- Object movement
- Environmental movement
- Camera movement
- Camera speed
- Timing
- Emotional progression
- Important visual events
- Ending position/state

Preserve the character appearance, clothing, environment, lighting, composition, ar

Do not introduce unnecessary movements or new visual elements.

The video prompt should describe controlled cinematic motion rather than simply rep
```

---

12. Generate → Edit → Compare → Iterate

```
Use the completed production plan to generate the video shot-by-shot.

After generating the shots:

1. Assemble the shots in chronological order.
2. Match the planned pacing and shot durations.
3. Add dialogue, music, ambience, and sound effects.
4. Compare the result against the reverse-engineered structure.
5. Check story clarity.
6. Check character consistency.
7. Check environment continuity.
8. Check camera and composition consistency.
9. Check emotional progression.
10. Check pacing and editing rhythm.
11. Identify the weakest shots.
12. Revise their image or video prompts.
13. Regenerate the necessary shots.
14. Reassemble and review again.

Prioritize narrative clarity, visual continuity, emotional impact, and pacing.
```

Final structure

```
REVERSE ENGINEERING
│
├── 1. Story Structure Analysis
├── 2. Scene Construction Analysis
├── 3. Visual Filmmaking Analysis
├── 4. Editing Strategy Analysis
├── 5. Dialogue Analysis
└── 6. Reusable Story Blueprint
        │
        ▼
PRODUCTION
│
├── 7. Production-Ready Recreation Plan
├── 8. Character Bible
├── 9. Environment / Location Bible
├── 10. Shot-by-Shot Image Prompts
├── 11. Shot-by-Shot Video Prompts
└── 12. Generate → Edit → Compare → Iterate
```

This is now the **clean canonical version** we've established, with the Step 6 original-story example removed.

in what step where i want to change character? example the original is a 20yr old boy and on my story i want to use 23 yr old girl

The **character change should happen between Step 6 and Step 7**, specifically when you create the **Character Bible**.

The cleanest approach is to separate **what you learned from the original** from **what you are changing for your own story**.

Recommended structure

```
ORIGINAL VIDEO
      |
      ▼
Steps 1–5
Analyze the original
      |
      ▼
Step 6
Extract reusable storytelling blueprint
      |
      ▼
YOUR ORIGINAL ADAPTATION
      |
      ├── Character changes
      ├── Setting changes
      ├── Conflict changes
      ├── Event changes
      └── Other creative changes
      |
      ▼
Step 7
Production-Ready Plan
      |
      ▼
Step 8
Character Bible
      |
      ▼
Step 9
Environment Bible
      |
      ▼
10–11
Image + Video Prompts
```

Example

Original:

> 20-year-old boy

Your version:

> 23-year-old girl

You **shouldn't modify the original analysis in Step 1–5**.

For example, Step 1 should still say:

> Protagonist: 20-year-old boy.

Because you're documenting what actually exists in the source.

Then Step 6 extracts the general structure:

> Young protagonist faces X → Y happens → protagonist encounters escalating obstacles → revelation → climax → resolution.

After that, you create your **adaptation specifications**:

> Original protagonist: 20-year-old boy
> New protagonist: 23-year-old girl

Then the Character Bible uses **your new character**, not the original.

I would add a new step

I recommend inserting this between Steps 6 and 7:

7. Original Story Adaptation

This is where you deliberately change the creative elements while preserving the useful structural mechanics.

```
Using the reusable storytelling blueprint from Step 6, create an ORIGINAL STORY AD

Preserve the underlying storytelling mechanics and structural principles, but repla

Define:

CHARACTERS
- Original character
```

```
- New character
- Age
- Gender
- Appearance
- Personality
- Character role
- Character relationships

SETTING
- Original setting
- New setting

CONFLICT
- Original conflict
- New conflict

STORY EVENTS
- Original major event
- New equivalent event

DIALOGUE
- Do not copy original dialogue.
- Define the purpose of the dialogue and create new dialogue appropriate to the nev

ENDING
- Identify the structural function of the original ending.
- Create a different ending that fulfills the same narrative function.

Make the new story substantially original while preserving the useful high-level st
```

Then your workflow becomes:

```
1. Story Structure Analysis
2. Scene Construction Analysis
3. Visual Filmmaking Analysis
4. Editing Strategy Analysis
5. Dialogue Analysis
6. Reusable Story Blueprint
7. Original Story Adaptation
8. Production-Ready Recreation Plan
9. Character Bible
10. Environment / Location Bible
11. Shot-by-Shot Image Prompts
12. Shot-by-Shot Video Prompts
13. Generate → Edit → Compare → Iterate
```

This is actually a better workflow for your goal.

Step 6 answers:

> **“What makes this type of story work?”**

Step 7 answers:

> **“How am I going to make my own story using those mechanics?”**

Then Steps 8–12 turn **your version** into production assets.

so everytime i create a video i need to execute from step to last?

No. You **should not run every step from 1 to 13 for every video**.

The better approach is to divide the workflow into **two phases**:

Phase A — Reverse Engineer the Reference

You only do this when you have a new reference video whose storytelling/visual style you want to study.

```
1. Story Structure Analysis
2. Scene Construction Analysis
3. Visual Filmmaking Analysis
4. Editing Strategy Analysis
5. Dialogue Analysis
6. Reusable Story Blueprint
```

The output is essentially your **reference video's DNA**.

You can save this as a reusable analysis document.

Phase B — Create Your Own Video

Once you have the blueprint, you don't need to analyze the reference again.

For each new video:

```
7. Original Story Adaptation
8. Production-Ready Recreation Plan
9. Character Bible
10. Environment / Location Bible
11. Shot-by-Shot Image Prompts
```

```
12. Shot-by-Shot Video Prompts
13. Generate → Edit → Compare → Iterate
```

Example

Suppose you analyze one successful AI drama:

> **Reference A → Steps 1–6**

You discover its formula:

```
Strong emotional hook
        ↓
Vulnerable protagonist
        ↓
Sudden injustice
        ↓
Attempt to solve problem
        ↓
Situation gets worse
        ↓
Unexpected intervention
        ↓
Major emotional payoff
        ↓
Resolution
```

You save that as:

```
Blueprint: Emotional Rescue Drama
```

Now you can create:

Video 1

```
Blueprint
   ↓
Step 7: New story
   ↓
Steps 8–13
```

Video 2

```
Same Blueprint
   ↓
Step 7: Completely different story
   ↓
Steps 8–13
```

Video 3

```
Same Blueprint
   ↓
Step 7: Another different story
   ↓
Steps 8–13
```

You don't redo Steps 1–6.

Even better: Build a Blueprint Library

This is where your workflow becomes much more efficient.

You could have:

```
Story Blueprint Library/

├── Emotional Rescue.md
├── Betrayal → Revenge.md
├── Poor → Rich Transformation.md
├── Bully → Consequence.md
├── Mystery → Revelation.md
├── Underdog → Victory.md
└── Family → Emotional Reunion.md
```

Each reference video you reverse engineer contributes **one reusable blueprint**.

Then when you want to make a new video:

```
Choose Blueprint
       ↓
Create Original Story
       ↓
Define Characters
       ↓
Define Locations
       ↓
Create Shot Plan
       ↓
Generate Images
       ↓
Generate Videos
       ↓
Edit
```

One important refinement

I would actually change the workflow slightly so that **Character Bible and Environment Bible happen during Step 7/8**, rather than treating them as something you blindly regenerate every time.

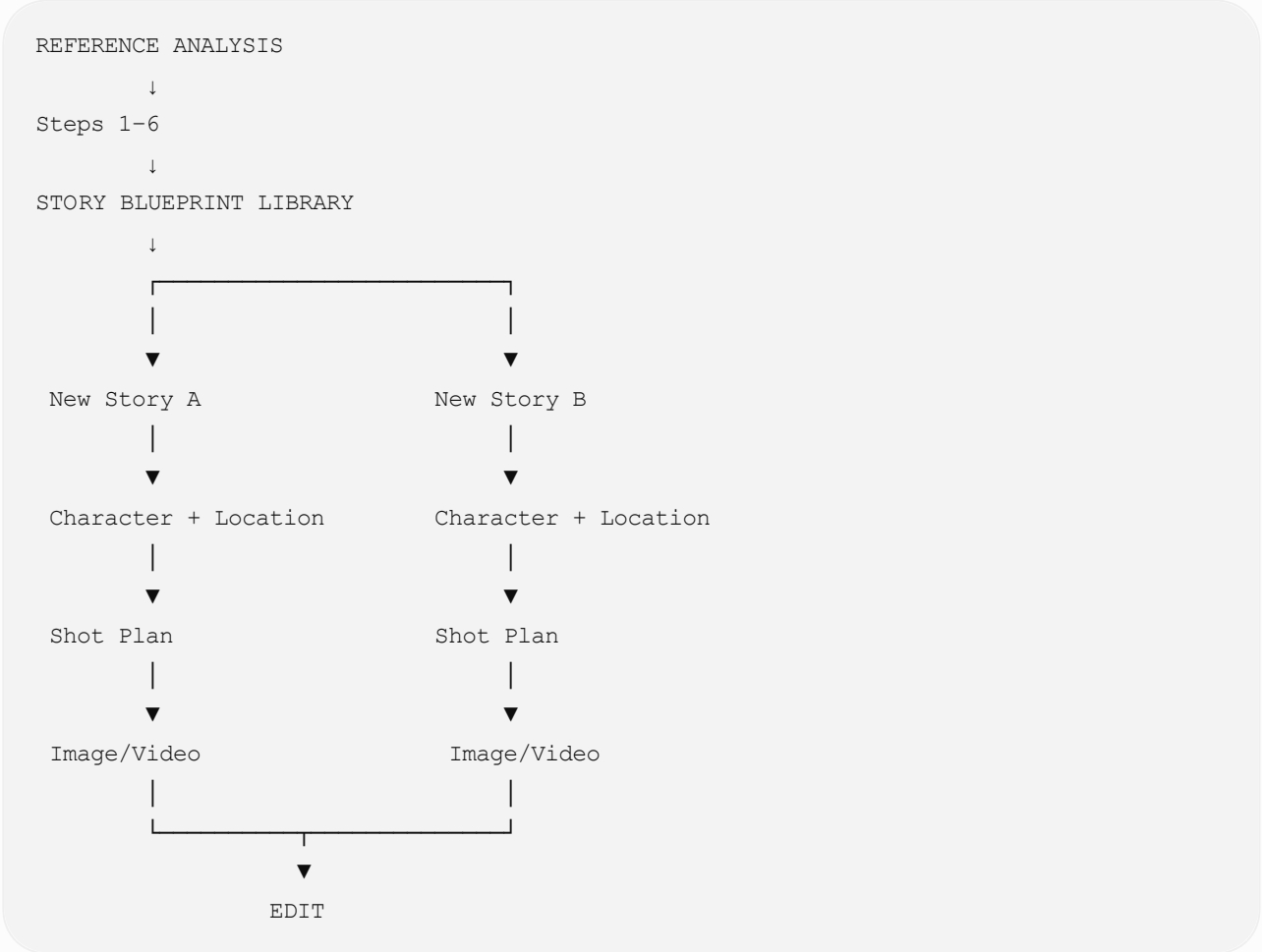
For example, if your recurring protagonist is:

> 23-year-old woman, long black hair, red jacket, etc.

You can maintain a **master character library**.

Then each new story simply references that character.

So you eventually have:



So the key principle is:

Steps 1–6 are research assets.

Steps 7 onward are production assets.

You build the research assets once, then reuse them across many videos.

so first analyze 1 video reference?

sample i upload 1 reference video to gemini and ask to perform step 1-6? then save the results as pdf?

Yes. That's the right starting architecture.

But I would **not ask Gemini to do Steps 1–6 in one giant prompt**. For reliable analysis, run the steps sequentially against the same uploaded reference video.

Recommended workflow

```
REFERENCE VIDEO #1
        |
        ▼
Upload to Gemini
        |
        ├── Step 1 → Story Structure
        |
        ├── Step 2 → Scene Construction
        |
        ├── Step 3 → Visual Filmmaking
        |
        ├── Step 4 → Editing Strategy
        |
        ├── Step 5 → Dialogue
        |
        └── Step 6 → Reusable Story Blueprint
        |
        ▼
Save analysis
        |
        ▼
REFERENCE BLUEPRINT
```

Why sequentially?

Because each step has a different analytical objective.

If you give Gemini all six prompts simultaneously, it may:

- Produce shallow analysis
- Repeat information between sections
- Miss visual details
- Spend too much context on earlier sections

- Treat the task as a general summary instead of six separate analyses

Sequential analysis lets you say:

> "Now perform Step 2 using the video and the Step 1 analysis."

That gives Step 2 useful context without mixing the objectives.

What I would save

I wouldn't make the **PDF the primary format**.

Use something structured like:

```
Reference_01/
│
├── source.mp4
│
├── 01-story-structure.md
├── 02-scene-construction.md
├── 03-visual-filmmaking.md
├── 04-editing-strategy.md
├── 05-dialogue.md
├── 06-story-blueprint.md
│
└── reference-analysis.pdf
```

The `.md` files are your **working source files**.

The PDF is your **human-readable archive/reference**.

This becomes important later because you can feed the Markdown analysis into Claude Code or another AI workflow without having to extract text from PDFs.

Then you have your reusable Blueprint

For example:

```
Reference_01/
└── 06-story-blueprint.md
```

might contain something like:

```
BLUEPRINT: Emotional Rescue Drama
```

```
HOOK
Introduce vulnerable character in immediate danger or humiliation.

SETUP
Establish protagonist's vulnerability and unfair situation.

INCITING INCIDENT
An antagonist creates a significant problem.

ESCALATION
The protagonist attempts to respond but the situation becomes worse.

TURNING POINT
An unexpected element changes the protagonist's situation.

CLIMAX
The protagonist's situation reaches its highest emotional/stakes point.

RESOLUTION
The conflict is resolved and the protagonist receives an emotional payoff.

PACING
Fast hook → short setup → escalating beats → brief suspense → dramatic payoff → emc
```

That blueprint is what you reuse.

Then create Video #1

You **do not upload the reference and repeat Steps 1–6**.

Instead:

```
06-story-blueprint.md
        │
        ▼
Step 7 — Original Story Adaptation
        │
        ├── New protagonist
        ├── New antagonist
        ├── New setting
        ├── New conflict
        ├── New events
        └── New ending
        │
        ▼
Step 8 — Production Plan
        │
        ▼
Step 9 — Character Bible
```

```
        |
        ▼
Step 10 — Environment Bible
        |
        ▼
Step 11 — Image Prompts
        |
        ▼
Step 12 — Video Prompts
        |
        ▼
Step 13 — Generate/Edit
```

So if your example is:

Reference:

> 20-year-old boy gets bullied → unexpected rescue → confrontation → emotional resolution

Your version could be:

> **23-year-old woman** → completely different situation → different characters → different events → same underlying emotional escalation/payoff structure.

The **20-year-old boy never needs to appear in your production Character Bible**.

One more important distinction

If you eventually find **10 good reference videos**, don't necessarily treat them as 10 separate workflows.

You can do:

```
Reference 01 → Steps 1–6 → Blueprint A
Reference 02 → Steps 1–6 → Blueprint B
Reference 03 → Steps 1–6 → Blueprint C
...
Reference 10 → Steps 1–6 → Blueprint J
```

Then you have a **Story Blueprint Library**.

Your production workflow becomes:

```
Choose Blueprint
      ↓
Create Original Story
```

```
      ↓
Create Characters
      ↓
Create Scenes
      ↓
Create Shots
      ↓
Generate
      ↓
Edit
```

That's the scalable system you're ultimately building.

what gpt are you using now?

I'm using **GPT-5.6 Luna**.

so step 1 - 6 paste to gemini sequentially? then as to print each result as md file?

Yes. That is the workflow I recommend.

Reference analysis workflow

```
Upload Reference Video to Gemini
            |
            ▼
       STEP 1 PROMPT
            |
            ▼
 Save result → 01-story-structure.md
            |
            ▼
       STEP 2 PROMPT
            |
            ▼
 Save result → 02-scene-construction.md
            |
            ▼
       STEP 3 PROMPT
            |
            ▼
```

```
Save result → 03-visual-filmmaking.md
           |
           ▼
      STEP 4 PROMPT
           |
           ▼
Save result → 04-editing-strategy.md
           |
           ▼
      STEP 5 PROMPT
           |
           ▼
Save result → 05-dialogue.md
           |
           ▼
      STEP 6 PROMPT
           |
           ▼
Save result → 06-story-blueprint.md
```

I would make one small change

Don't ask Gemini to **"print as MD"** and rely on the formatting being perfect.

Instead, after each analysis, tell Gemini:

```
Return the analysis in clean Markdown format.
Do not wrap the entire response in a code block.
Use clear Markdown headings, tables where useful, bullet lists, and timestamps.
```

Then save the response directly as the corresponding `.md` file.

Your folder becomes:

```
Reference_001/
|
├── reference-video.mp4
|
├── 01-story-structure.md
├── 02-scene-construction.md
├── 03-visual-filmmaking.md
├── 04-editing-strategy.md
├── 05-dialogue.md
└── 06-story-blueprint.md
```

One important thing

For **Steps 2–6**, keep the previous analyses available to Gemini.

For example, after Step 1:

> "Now perform Step 2. Use the original video plus the Step 1 analysis below as context."

Then paste Step 1's result.

For Step 3, provide:

- Original video
- Step 1 result
- Step 2 result

And so on.

This creates a cumulative analysis rather than six disconnected analyses.

However, **Step 6 doesn't need all the raw outputs pasted repeatedly if Gemini already has them in the same conversation/context**. If you're starting a fresh chat or context becomes too large, provide the saved Markdown files instead.

Final result

After analyzing one reference:

```
Reference_001/
├── 01-story-structure.md
├── 02-scene-construction.md
├── 03-visual-filmmaking.md
├── 04-editing-strategy.md
├── 05-dialogue.md
└── 06-story-blueprint.md
```

The most valuable file for future story creation is `06-story-blueprint.md`.

The other five files are the evidence/detail behind that blueprint and remain useful when you need to reproduce the reference's **visual language, pacing, scene construction, or dialogue mechanics**.

ChatGPT can make mistakes. Check important info.